Ensuring abilities' correctness

Our application will get big and challenging to maintain. When we have lots of rules, we need to make sure they work as expected. Luckily, CanCan makes testing and debugging privileges delightful.

Testing

Testing abilities can be done using several test frameworks such as **Test::Unit**, **RSpec**, and **Cucumber**. In this section, we will use RSpec for testing abilities.

CanCan provides an **RSpec** matcher (`be_able_to`) to make it convenient to test abilities:

```
# specs/models/ability_spec.rb
require "cancan/matchers"
require "spec_helper"

describe Ability do
  describe "destroying a post" do
    describe "guest user" do
      let(:ability) { Ability.new nil }

      it "cannot destroy a post" do
        ability.should_not be_able_to(
          :destroy, Post.new(user: nil))
        ability.should_not be_able_to(
          :destroy, Post.new)
      end
    end
  end
end
```

Debugging

You can debug the defined abilities in a Rails console, during test or during development. In general, the following are the steps to debug abilities:

1. Fetch a user and a model you would like to debug using the following code snippet:

```
user = User.first # a user you want to check
post = Post.first # a model you want to check
ability = Ability.new(user)
```


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